

The Pajama Parade

An original bedtime story for ages 4–7. Reading time: about 4 minutes.



Kids Book Videos



Dina the duckling loved her yellow dress. She wore it all day long. But when bedtime came, her mother held out her pajamas. They were blue with tiny stars.

"I do not want pajamas," said Dina. She felt grumpy. "I want my yellow dress."

Her mother did not argue. She just smiled a secret smile. "All right," she said. "But the parade starts soon."

"What parade?" asked Dina. She felt curious now.



Just then, she heard music. Toot-toot went a tiny trumpet. It came from under her bed! Dina peeked under. Her toy elephant was marching out. He wore tiny red pajamas.

"The Pajama Parade is starting!" trumpeted the elephant. Behind him marched her doll. The doll wore pink polka-dot pajamas. Behind the doll hopped her bunny. The bunny wore green striped pajamas.

Dina giggled. "Where are you going?" she asked.



"To bed, of course!" said the elephant. "Everyone marches in pajamas. It is the rule of the parade."

One by one, her toys marched past. Each wore the silliest, softest pajamas. Dina felt left out. She was the only one not in the parade.

She looked at her blue starry pajamas. They did look rather cozy. She slipped off her yellow dress. She pulled the pajamas over her head. They felt soft as a cloud.



"March, march, into bed!" sang the toys.

Dina joined the end of the line. She marched around her bedroom. Left, right, left, right. Her mother clapped along. Dina felt happy and proud.

"March, march, into bed!" sang the toys again.

The parade marched toward her bed. The elephant climbed onto the pillow. The doll snuggled by the blanket. The bunny curled up at the foot. Dina climbed in after them.

"March, march, into bed!" sang the toys one last time.



Then the parade was over. Everyone was tucked in. Dina's starry pajamas kept her warm. Her toys were quiet now. Her eyes felt heavy.

Sleep now, little duckling. You marched beautifully in the Pajama Parade. Dream of soft stars and silly marches.

***Moral:** Bedtime routines are more fun when you make them a celebration.*

The End